Control Regime, the Wassenaar Arrangement (which governs the export conventional and dual-use weapons) and the Australia Group (which controls the spread of chemical and biological weapons). Membership at the Nuclear Suppliers Group continued to be blocked by China. In terms of climate negotiations, while India had earlier worked with the 'BASIC' coalition—including China, Brazil and South Africa—to negotiate with the West at the Copenhagen Climate Summit in 2009, a different outcome was managed at the Paris Climate Summit in late 2015. This time, India worked with hosts France not only to commit to a nationally determined contribution (NDC)—helping to ensure that the Summit was a success—but announced the co-development of an International Solar Alliance (ISA). [34] The ISA was somewhat new territory for Indian diplomacy, in that it involved the establishment of a treaty-based international organization. India's experience in this respect brought a new angle to its multilateral diplomacy and was replicated with the founding of a Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI) and other issue-specific international institutions.

New Mandate: Domestic and Foreign Policy, 2019–2020

Modi and the BJP won re-election in 2019 with an even larger political mandate. For the first ten months, his government focused on major domestic objectives, some of which had been longstanding BJP positions. The first—in August 2019—involved nullifying Article 370 of the Constitution, a temporary provision that had granted Jammu and Kashmir special status. Furthermore, Jammu and Kashmir was made into a Union Territory and divided, with the region of Ladakh becoming autonomous. The move elicited criticism from Pakistan and, to a lesser degree, China, and India expended diplomatic capital to explain to the international community that this was a strictly domestic matter. (For its part, Pakistan had more than once changed the status of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir.) Some of the international criticism related less to India's actual action as the means it employed, such as the detention of Kashmiri political leaders,